

GO FORTH AND PROSPER

Those are five golden rules for you. They all really do meld together, along with the other advice I've offered, which they should, if one has a consistent point of view about investing. Mine hasn't changed much from my early days in money management. It has only been reinforced, and refined a bit, by years of experience.

Maintain independence of thought and a healthy degree of skepticism, so you won't be drawn into the herd. Don't overpay, no matter how much you like a company. Invest in themes that will give a company a long-term franchise. Invest downstream from technology. Think and invest globally. Find stocks to own, not trade.

It's not all that complicated. Common sense and patience make a successful investor.